HEALTHWATCH: SOCIAL MEDIA ANXIETY *PG 11*

GRAPHIC: FATAL FOOTPATHS *PG 12*



▶ PRIVATE INVESTMENT

GREEN SHOOTS OF REVIVAL

Infrastructure and new-age sectors are leading the uptick, but companies still remain cautious about adding capacity

By M.G. ARUN

TWO SETS OF DATA WERE KEENLY WATCHED WHEN THE GOVERNMENT RELEASED the first-quarter GDP numbers for the current financial year: investment and consumption, the economy's prime growth engines. Investment grew nearly 12 per cent year-on-year in the first quarter, while consumption expanded 7 per cent.

The investment numbers were particularly significant. For several years, the Centre has been spending heavily on capital expenditure to boost infrastructure, with the expectation that this investment would trigger a wave of investment by the corporate sector and help create the jobs the country badly needs. However, private investment has remained sluggish, leaving policymakers grappling with how to get the private sector to step up.

The National Statistical Office (NSO), part of the Union ministry of statistics and programme

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS**